

❖ Ch 3 – Two Stories about Flying ❖



Summary.

I. His First Flight – by Liam O' Flaherty

A young seagull is alone on a ledge. His two brothers, sister and parents have flown away. He is afraid to fly because he thinks his wings will not support him. His parents try to make him fly but he fails.

He is hungry for 24 hours. His mother takes a piece of fish and flies near him but does not give

it. Mad with hunger, the young seagull dives for fish. He falls down and gets scared, but then his wings open automatically and he starts flying. He makes his first flight. His family praises him. He overcomes his fear.

সাৰাংশ

I. তেওঁৰ প্ৰথম উৰণ - লিয়াম অ' ফ্লেহাৰ্টিৰ দ্বাৰা এটা লেজত অকলে এটা পোৱালি ছিগাল। তেওঁৰ দুই ভাতৃ, ভগ্নী আৰু পিতৃ-মাতৃ উৰা মাৰিছে। উৰিবলৈ ভয় কৰে কাৰণ তেওঁ ভাবিছে যে তেওঁৰ ডেউকাবোৰে তেওঁক সমৰ্থন নকৰে। মাক-দেউতাকে তাক উৰাবলৈ চেষ্টা কৰে কিন্তু সি বিফল হয়। ২৪ ঘণ্টা ধৰি তেওঁ ভোকত আছে। মাকে মাছৰ টুকুৰা এটা লৈ তাৰ ওচৰত উৰি যায় যদিও নিদিয়ৈ। ভোকত উন্মাদ, পোৱালি চেঙলে মাছৰ বাবে ডুব মাৰে। সি তললৈ পৰি ভয় খায়, কিন্তু তাৰ পিছত ডেউকা দুখন স্বয়ংক্ৰিয়ভাৱে খোল খায় আৰু সি উৰিবলৈ আৰম্ভ কৰে। তেওঁ প্ৰথম উৰণ কৰে। তেওঁৰ পৰিয়ালে তেওঁক প্ৰশংসা কৰে। তেওঁ নিজৰ ভয়ক জয় কৰে।

6 Important Questions Answers – His First Flight

Q1. Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?

Ans: He thought his wings would not support him

and he would fall into the sea. He lacked confidence.

Q2. What did his family do when he was afraid?

Ans: His parents, brothers and sister scolded and threatened him to fly, but when he refused they left him alone on the ledge.

Q3. How was he alone for 24 hours?

Ans: His family flew away to the other rock. He was hungry and could not find food, so he was alone and starving for 24 hours.

Q4. How did his mother trick him to make him fly?

Ans: His mother tore a piece of fish and flew near him but stopped just out of his reach. Mad with hunger, he dived for the fish and fell, and his wings opened.

Q5. What happened after his first flight?

Ans: He was scared at first but then he started soaring and diving. His family came near him, praised him and gave him fish. He was happy.

Q6. What is the message of the story?

Ans: The story teaches that we must have courage and confidence to overcome fear. The first step is always difficult but we must take it.

◆◆◆◆Thinking about the Text◆◆◆◆◆

1. Why was the young seagull afraid to fly? Do you think all young birds are afraid to make their first flight, or are some birds more timid than others? Do you think a human baby also finds it a challenge to take its first steps?

Ans: The young seagull was afraid to fly because he thought his wings would not support him and

he would fall into the sea. It was his first flight and he lacked confidence.

Yes, I think all young birds are afraid to make their first flight to some extent. Like humans, birds also feel fear for new things. Some birds are more timid than others, just like humans.

Yes, a human baby also finds it a challenge to take its first steps. It is afraid of falling down. But with help and encouragement from parents, it learns to walk, just like the seagull learned to fly with his mother's help.

2. "The sight of the food maddened him." What does this suggest? What compelled the young seagull to finally fly?

Ans: This suggests that the young seagull was very hungry for 24 hours. When he saw his

mother bringing fish, he became mad with hunger and wanted to eat it badly.

Hunger compelled the young seagull to finally fly. His mother tricked him by stopping just out of his reach. He dived for the food and fell from the ledge, and then his wings opened and he flew.

**3. "They were beckoning to him, calling shrilly."
Why did the seagull's father and mother threaten him and cajole him to fly?**

Ans: The seagull's father and mother threatened and cajoled him to fly because they wanted him to learn flying. They knew if he does not fly, he will starve and die alone on the ledge. They wanted to make him confident, like his brothers and sister. It was for his own good and survival.

4. Have you ever had a similar experience, where your parents encouraged you to do something that you were too scared to try? Discuss this in pairs or groups.

Ans: Yes, I had a similar experience. When I was small, I was very scared to ride a bicycle. I thought I would fall down and get hurt. My father encouraged me and held the bicycle from behind. He told me I can do it. One day he left the bicycle and I rode alone without knowing it. I was happy. Now I can ride easily.

Just like the young seagull, I was afraid at first, but with my parents' encouragement, I overcame my fear.

5. In the case of a bird flying, it seems a natural act, and a foregone conclusion that it should succeed. In the examples you have given in

answer to the previous question, was your success guaranteed, or was it important for you to try, regardless of a possibility of failure?

Ans: For a bird, flying is natural and success is guaranteed if it tries. But for humans, success is not guaranteed.

In my bicycle example, my success was not guaranteed. I could have fallen down and failed. But it was important for me to try, regardless of possibility of failure. If I had not tried, I would have never learned to ride. Trying is more important than fearing failure.

□□II. Black Aeroplane – by Frederick Forsyth□□



Summary

A pilot is flying his old Dakota aeroplane from France to England at night. He wants to reach home for breakfast with family.

Midway he enters big black storm clouds. His compass, radio and instruments stop working. Fuel is low. He is lost.

Suddenly he sees another black aeroplane without lights beside him. Its pilot signals him to follow. He follows the black aeroplane through the storm and lands safely.

After landing, he asks the control room about the other pilot who helped him. The woman says there was no other plane in the storm. It is a mystery who helped him.

Moral: Have courage to take first step, and have faith in difficult times.

সাৰাংশ

এজন পাইলটে নিজৰ পুৰণি ডাকোটা বিমানখন ফ্ৰান্সৰ পৰা ইংলেণ্ডলৈ নিশা উৰুৱাই লৈ গৈছে। পৰিয়ালৰ সৈতে ব্ৰেকফাষ্ট কৰিবলৈ ঘৰ পাব বিচাৰে। মাজ বাটত সি ডাঙৰ ডাঙৰ ক'লা ধুমুহাৰ ডাৱৰবোৰৰ মাজত সোমাই পৰে। তেওঁৰ কম্পাছ, ৰেডিঅ' আৰু বাদ্যযন্ত্ৰৰ কাম বন্ধ হৈ যায়। ইন্ধন কম। হেৰাই গৈছে সি। হঠাৎ তেওঁৰ কাষত লাইট নথকা আন এখন ক'লা বিমান দেখা পায়। ইয়াৰ পাইলটে তেওঁক অনুসৰণ কৰিবলৈ

ইংগিত দিয়ে। ধুমুহাৰ মাজেৰে ক'লা বিমানখনৰ পিছে পিছে গৈ
তেওঁ নিৰাপদে অৱতৰণ কৰে। অৱতৰণ কৰাৰ পিছত কণ্ট্ৰল
ৰুমত তেওঁক সহায় কৰা আনজন পাইলটৰ বিষয়ে সুধিছে।
মহিলাগৰাকীয়ে কয় যে ধুমুহাত আন কোনো বিমান নাছিল।
কোনে তেওঁক সহায় কৰিলে সেয়া এক ৰহস্য।

নৈতিকতা: প্ৰথম পদক্ষেপ ল'বলৈ সাহস ৰাখক, আৰু কঠিন
সময়ত বিশ্বাস ৰাখক।

◆◆◆◆◆Thinking about the Text◆◆◆◆◆

1. "I'll take the risk." What is the risk? Why does the narrator take it?

Ans: The risk is to fly his old Dakota aeroplane directly into the storm clouds.

The narrator takes it because:

1. He wanted to reach England quickly to have breakfast with his family.
2. He did not have enough fuel to fly around the big black clouds, so going through them was the only way.

2. Describe the narrator's experience as he flew the aeroplane into the storm.

Ans: As he flew into the storm, everything went black. He could not see anything outside. His aeroplane jumped and twisted in the air. His compass and other instruments stopped working. He was lost and could not contact anyone on the radio. He felt helpless and thought he would die.

3. Why does the narrator say, "I landed and was not sorry to walk away from the old Dakota..."?

Ans: He says this because he had a terrible experience in the storm. He was lost in black clouds and thought he would crash and die. After landing safely, he felt relieved to be on the ground and away from the old, risky Dakota.

4. What made the woman in the control centre look at the narrator strangely?

Ans: The woman in the control centre looked at him strangely because he asked about the black aeroplane and its pilot who helped him. She told him that no other aeroplane was flying that night in the storm. She thought his question was strange because on the radar there was only his Dakota in the sky.

5. Who do you think helped the narrator to reach safely? Discuss this among yourselves and give reasons for your answer.

Ans: I think it was the narrator's own imagination or maybe a mysterious power / guardian angel that helped him.

It could be his own courage and subconscious mind that showed him the way, which he imagined as another pilot. Or it could be a supernatural help, as the story is a mystery.

It shows that in times of trouble, some unknown power helps us and gives us hope to survive.

★★★Thinking about Language★★★

I. The word **black** has different meanings in different contexts:

1. Go and have a bath; your hands and face are absolutely black.

› **Meaning: Very dirty / full of dirt or soot.**

2. The taxi-driver gave Ratan a black look as he crossed the road when the traffic light was green.

› **Meaning: An angry, hostile or threatening look.**

3. The bombardment of Hiroshima is one of the blackest crimes against humanity.

› **Meaning: Wickedest / most evil / most shameful.**

4. Very few people enjoy Harold Pinter's black comedy.

› **Meaning: Dark comedy – a comedy that deals with depressing, serious or tragic subjects in a humorous way.**

5. Sometimes shopkeepers store essential goods to create false scarcity and then sell these in black.

› **Meaning: In black market / illegally for more money.**

6. Villagers had beaten the criminal black and blue.

➤ **Meaning: Severely beaten, so badly that his body became covered with bruises.**

II. Match Column A with Column B

1. Fly a flag – Display a flag on a long pole
 2. Fly into rage – Become suddenly very angry
 3. Fly along – Move quickly / suddenly
 4. Fly high – Be successful
 5. Fly the coop – Escape from a place
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III. Words which have same or nearly same meaning as 'fly' (of birds/insects):

The correct words are:

swoop, flit, flutter, float, dart, hover, glide, soar, sail, skim, flap, ascend

These words all show movement through air like
a bird.
